he enjoys today. So, let's not get into these metrics. The metrics can be gamed. We are not in the business of gaming metrics. We are in the business of winning elections and that's what we have done fairly successfully. So, I am not even going to go down that path. You say they upped the game. They didn't, because if they did, the end data would show something, right? I'm happy to have a BJP Twitter account at 1.2 crore with the kind of retweet numbers that it has. As long as I'm making the impact, I don't want an account which has 10,000 retweets and doesn't make an impact on it. Most people get social media wrong. Social media is not about the metrics that you've seen. It's really about what's the kind of impact that you're making.'[43]

He's speaking like a party spokesperson, but he does have a point about Facebook: 'Rahul Gandhi's Twitter account is on steroids, but when you look at his Facebook account, the same post gets hardly any traction. How's it possible, because Facebook is a much larger community than Twitter? So, you know, these are all good things for newspaper columns in the run-up to the elections. Their metrics are not good. If you really want to compare Rahul Gandhi's Twitter account performance, compare it to Smriti Irani, who is someone he was contesting against and she beat him.'

So, was the Congress relying more on bots than the BJP? Joyojeet Pal, whose team studied Twitter patterns of 18,000 political accounts, also found results similar to ours on Twitter: Congress and Rahul Gandhi started doing better on retweets between 2017 and 2019. 'Congress on average gets retweeted more than BJP but on aggregate BJP is way higher,' he said. 'The catch is we don't know how many of these are bots. But at a measurement level we should take the aggregate number. Rahul speaks less but when he speaks, he gets more traction.'[44]

Gandhi just tried, says Pal, to 'redo what Modi was doing in the 2014 campaign and did it well, but just that gaming in and of itself is not sufficient. It's also about which topics to pick, how certain topics can be made to trend. It is not just what one person says. In that sense Rahul got some elements right but didn't have the organization to match up.'[45]